



INKSCAPE • GIMP • KRITA • SCRIBUS

DOC NO. RL-BRAND-001-FOSS-A REV. A RIPOSTE LABORATORIES

The open-source stack, which is where most Riposte production artwork actually gets made.

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SEC.01

1 • INSTALL THE PALETTE

`../palettes/riposte.gpl` – the GIMP palette format, shared by Inkscape, GIMP and Krita.

APP	INSTALL TO
Inkscape (Linux)	<code>~/.config/inkscape/palettes/</code>
Inkscape (macOS)	<code>~/Library/Application Support/org.inkscape.Inkscape/config/inkscape/palettes/</code>
Inkscape (Windows)	<code>%APPDATA%\inkscape\palettes\</code>
GIMP	<code>~/.config/GIMP/2.10/palettes/</code> (or 3.0)
Krita	Settings → Manage Resources → Import Resource

BASH

```
# Linux, both at once
cp palettes/riposte.gpl ~/.config/inkscape/palettes/
cp palettes/riposte.gpl ~/.config/GIMP/2.10/palettes/
```

Restart. In Inkscape, pick **Riposte Laboratories** from the palette selector at the far right of the swatch strip. In GIMP, **Windows → Dockable Dialogs → Palettes**.

Scribus reads GPL too: **Edit → Colours and Fills → Import → riposte.gpl**.

SEC.02

2 • FONT

Install JetBrains Mono system-wide:

BASH

```
# Debian / Ubuntu
sudo apt install fonts-jetbrains-mono
# Arch
sudo pacman -S ttf-jetbrains-mono
# manual, any Linux
mkdir -p ~/.local/share/fonts && cp JetBrainsMono-*.ttf ~/.local/share/fonts/ && fc-cache -f
```

Verify: `fc-list | grep -i jetbrains`

SEC.03

3 • INKSCAPE

DOCUMENT

File → Document Properties — background `#F6F1E7FF` (note the alpha byte), display units px, and enable a **2px grid** to match the system's spacing scale.

OBJECTS

- ▶ **Rectangles:** `Rx/Ry = 0`. Inkscape remembers the last corner radius you used, so reset it explicitly or every new rectangle inherits it.
- ▶ **Strokes:** 2px structural, 1px dashed dividers, 6px accent top bars, 8px left bars. Set **Stroke style** → **Join: miter**, **Cap: butt** – round joins soften the corners you just squared off.
- ▶ **No filters.** Inkscape's blur slider and every entry in **Filters** → **Shadows and Glows** are off-limits.
- ▶ **Hard offset:** duplicate (`Ctrl+D`), fill with the accent, **Page Down**, then **Transform** → **Move** by 4, 4 px.

THE THREE PATTERNS

- ▶ **Checker:** 22px square → duplicate into a 2×2 alternating block → select → **Object** → **Pattern** → **Objects to Pattern** (`Alt+I`). Band 26px with 2px ink rules.
- ▶ **Harlequin:** 34px squares rotated 45°, alternating pink/teal → same pattern step. Band 38px.
- ▶ **Tri-band:** linear gradient at 105°, with **doubled stops** at 36% and 64% so the boundaries stay hard. Inkscape will interpolate otherwise.

EXPORT

- ▶ **Web:** **Export PNG**, 2× for retina; or Plain SVG (**not** Inkscape SVG – it carries editor cruft)
- ▶ **Print:** **Save As** → **PDF**, text as text with fonts embedded, 3mm bleed

SEC.04

4 • GIMP

Mostly for raster touch-up; the brand barely uses photography.

- Set the foreground colour from the palette dock rather than typing hex each time
- **No layer effects.** Every one is a blur, a bevel or a glow
- Text tool: JetBrains Mono, and set letter spacing in the tool options – GIMP's units are pixels, so at 12px, `.1em` $\approx$ **1.2px**
- Export PNG for flat artwork, never JPEG

SEC.05

5 • KRITA

Charts, diagrams and illustration. Same rules: flat fills, hard edges, no blur, no gradients except the three functional patterns. Import the GPL and work from it.

SEC.06

6 • SCRIBUS

The FOSS print path. See `../docs/08-print.md` RL-BRAND-001-PRINT first.

- Import `riposte.gpl` via **Edit → Colours and Fills**
- Document: 15mm margins, 3mm bleed
- **Line weights $\geq$ 1.5pt.** Scribus will happily render a 0.25pt hairline that vanishes at press
- Master pages carry the corner marks and the colophon
- Export **PDF/X-4**, fonts embedded, bleed on, crop marks on

SEC.07

7 • COMMAND LINE

Regenerate every palette export from `brand/tokens.json`:

BASH

```
node scripts/build.js
```

Convert artwork:

BASH

```
# SVG → PNG at 2x
inkscape logo.svg --export-type=png --export-width=1440 -o logo@2x.png

# SVG → PDF with text preserved
inkscape sheet.svg --export-type=pdf --export-text-to-path=false -o sheet.pdf

# recolour a logo variant (the three official fills)
sed 's/#1d1a17/#f6f1e7/g' assets/logo/riposte-ink.svg > riposte-bone.svg
```

SEC.08

8 • CHECKLIST

- ☐ `riposte.gpl` installed and selected
- ☐ JetBrains Mono installed, `fc-cache` run
- ☐ Rectangle `Rx/Ry` reset to 0
- ☐ No blur filters anywhere
- ☐ Strokes: miter joins, butt caps, $\geq 1.5\text{pt}$ for print
- ☐ Plain SVG on export, not Inkscape SVG
- ☐ Colophon present

SOURCE tools/inkscape-gimp.tex SHA e875880fc7ac BUILT 2026-09-07